“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 14

A Brief Description of the Childhood Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The fourteenth chapter describes the Lord’s childhood pastimes: He crawls on all fours; on the pretext of crying He spreads the holy name; on the pretext of eating earth He gives knowledge to His mother; He gives prasāda to a guest brāhmaṇa and delivers him; He climbs onto a thief’s shoulders, bewilders him and brings him back to His own home; on the pretext of illness He eats, on the day of Ekādaśī, the offering (*naivedya*) of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa; His childhood mischief; seeing His mother unconscious, He brings her coconuts; He jokes with the girls on the bank of the Gaṅgā; He accepts the worship of Lakṣmī-devī; sitting in a pit full of discarded pots, He gives His mother knowledge of Brahman and obeys her order; Miśra’s pure parental love (*śuddha-vātsalya*). These are the topics of the childhood pastimes.

(Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, vilāsa 20, verse 1)

কথঞ্চন স্মৃতে যস্মিন্ দুষ্করং সুকরং ভবেৎ ।
বিস্মৃতে বিপরীতং স্যাৎ শ্রীচৈতন্যমমুং ভজে ॥ ১ ॥

kathañcana smṛte yasmin
in any way being remembered whom
duṣkaraṁ sukaraṁ bhavet
the difficult easy becomes
vismṛte viparītaṁ syāt
being forgotten the reverse becomes
śrī-caitanyam amuṁ bhaje
Śrī Caitanya Him I worship

1 "I worship Śrī Caitanya. Remember Him in any way at all, and the difficult becomes easy; forget Him, and the easy becomes difficult." (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 20.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He whom one need only remember a little for the difficult to become easy, and whom one need only forget for even the easy to become difficult — that Caitanya I worship.

Anubhāṣya.
yasmin (in whom — in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **kathañcana** (in whatever way) **smṛte** (when He has come to mind) **duṣkaraṁ** (a difficult task) **sukaraṁ** (an easily performed practice) **bhavet**, **yasmin** (in whom — in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **vismṛte** (when He is forgotten) **viparītaṁ** (the reverse: an easily performed practice becomes a difficult task) **syāt**, **tam amuṁ śrī-caitanyam bhaje**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য, জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র, জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya, jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaitacandra, jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

প্রভুর কহিল এই জন্মলীলা-সূত্র ।
যশোদা-নন্দন যৈছে হৈল শচীপুত্র ॥ ৩ ॥

prabhura kahila ei janmalīlā-sūtra
of the Lord I have told this of the birth-pastime the outline
yaśodā-nandana yaiche haila śacī-putra
of Yaśodā the son how became Śacī's son

3 Thus I have given an outline of the Lord's birth, telling how the son of Yaśodā became the son of Śacī.

সংক্ষেপে কহিল জন্মলীলা-অনুক্রম ।
এবে কহি বাল্যলীলা-সূত্রের গণন ॥ ৪ ॥

saṅkṣepe kahila janma-līlā-anukrama
in brief I have told of the birth-pastimes the sequence
ebe kahi bālyalīlā-sūtrera gaṇana
now I tell of the childhood pastimes' outline the account

4 I have told the pastimes of His birth briefly and in order; now I shall name, one by one, the chief events of His childhood.

Gaura's pastimes are transcendental, though they resemble human ones —

বন্দে চৈতন্যকৃষ্ণস্য বাল্যলীলাং মনোহরাম্ ।
লৌকিকীমপি তামীশ-চেষ্টয়া বলিতান্তরাম্ ॥ ৫ ॥

vande caitanya-kṛṣṇasya
I worship of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa
bālya-līlāṁ mano-harām
the childhood pastimes enchanting
laukikīm api tām īśa-
worldly though them by the Lord's
ceṣṭayā valitāntarām
acts inwardly imbued

5 I worship the enchanting childhood pastimes of Kṛṣṇa, who came as Caitanya. Though they seem like the doings of an ordinary human child,

within they are interwoven with the acts of the Lord Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to the charming childhood pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa. Although these childhood pastimes resemble ordinary, worldly play, the deeds of the Lord are mixed into them.

Anubhāṣya.
caitanya-devasya (of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **laukikīm** (resembling the doings of people in this world) **api īśa-ceṣṭayā** (by superhuman endeavour) **valitāntarām** (those whose inner core is *valita*, endowed [with it]), **mano-harām** (attracting the heart) **bālya-līlām** (childhood play) **ahaṁ vande**.

He shows the marks of the conch, disc, flag, thunderbolt and fish on His soles

—

বাল্যলীলায় আগে প্রভুর উত্তান শয়ন ।
পিতা-মাতায় দেখাইল চিহ্ন চরণ ॥ ৬ ॥

bālya-līlāya āge prabhura uttāna śayana
in the childhood pastimes first the Lord's face-up lying
pitā-mātāya dekhāila cihna caraṇa
to father and mother He showed the marks of the feet

6 At the very start of His childhood pastimes, as Śrī Caitanya lay on His back, He showed His father and mother the divine marks on His feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Uttāna: lying face upward, on the back. There is a variant reading, *utthāna*. In that sense: trying to stand on His feet, He cannot keep His balance for lack of practice, as is natural for an infant, and lies down.

গৃহে দুই জন দেখি' লঘুপদ-চিহ্ন ।
তাহাতেই ধ্বজ, বজ্র, শঙ্খ, চক্র, মীন ॥ ৭ ॥

gṛhe dui jana dekhi' laghupada-cihna
in the house the two seeing of small feet the prints
tāhātei dhvaja, vajra, śaṅkha, cakra, mīna
in them indeed flag, thunderbolt, conch, disc, fish

7 In the house the two of them saw the prints of tiny feet, and in them a flag, a thunderbolt, a conch, a disc and a fish.

দেখিয়া দোঁহার চিত্তে জন্মিল বিস্ময় ।
কার পদচিহ্ন ঘরে, না পায় নিশ্চয় ॥ ৮ ॥

dekhiyā doṁhāra citte janmila vismaya
seeing of both in the hearts arose wonder
kāra pada-cihna ghare, nā pāya niścaya
whose footprints in the house not they find certainty

8 At the sight both were filled with wonder, unable to tell whose footprints these could be.

Miśra's words —

মিশ্র কহে, — বালগোপাল আছে শিলা-সঙ্গে ।
তিঁহো মূর্ত্তি-হঞা খেলে, জানি, ঘরে রঙ্গে ॥ ৯ ॥

miśra kahe, — bālagopāla āche śilā-saṅge
Miśra says — the child Gopāla is with the śilā
tiṁho mūrti-hañā khele, jāni, ghare raṅge
He taking a form plays, I think, in the house for His delight

9 Miśra said, "The child Gopāla is present in our *śālagrāma-śilā*. I think He takes on a form and plays about the house for His own delight."

সেই ক্ষণে জাগি' নিমাই করয়ে ক্রন্দন ।
অঙ্কে লঞা শচী তাঁরে পিয়াইল স্তন ॥ ১০ ॥

sei kṣaṇe jāgi' nimāi karaye krandana
at that moment waking Nimāi begins crying
aṅke lañā śacī tāṁre piyāila stana
on her lap taking Śacī to Him gave to drink the breast

10 At that moment Nimāi woke and began to cry. Śacī took Him on her lap and nursed Him.

Both Śacī and Miśra see the marks on Nimāi's feet —

স্তন পিয়াইতে পুত্রের চরণ দেখিল ।
সেই চিহ্ন পায়ে দেখি' — মিশ্রে বোলাইল ॥ ১১ ॥

stana piyāite putrera caraṇa dekhila
the breast while giving of her son the feet she saw
sei cihna pāye dekhi' — miśre bolāila
those marks on His feet seeing — Miśra she called

11 As she nursed Him, she looked at her son's feet, and when she saw those same marks on them, she called Miśra.

দেখিয়া মিশ্রের হৈল আনন্দিত মতি ।
গুপ্তে বোলাইল নীলাম্বর চক্রবর্ত্তী ॥ ১২ ॥

dekhiyā miśrera haila ānandita mati
seeing Miśra's became joyful mind
gupte bolāila nīlāmbara cakravartī
secretly he called Nīlāmbara Cakravartī

12 The sight filled Miśra's heart with joy, and he quietly sent for Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

Nīlāmbara Cakravartī's words —

চিহ্ন দেখি' চক্রবর্ত্তী বলেন হাসিয়া ।
লগ্ন গণি' পূর্ব্বে আমি রাখিয়াছি লিখিয়া ॥ ১৩ ॥

cihna dekhi' cakravartī balena hāsiyā
the marks seeing Cakravartī says smiling
lagna gaṇi' pūrve āmi rākhiyāchi likhiyā
the birth-chart reckoning earlier I have kept written down

13 Seeing the marks, Cakravartī smiled and said, "When I cast His birth chart, I foresaw this and wrote it down.

বত্রিশ লক্ষণ — মহাপুরুষ-ভূষণ ।
এই শিশু-অঙ্গে দেখি সে সব লক্ষণ ॥ ১৪ ॥

batriśa lakṣaṇa — mahāpuruṣa-bhūṣaṇa
thirty-two marks — of a great personality the ornaments
ei śiśu-aṅge dekhi se saba lakṣaṇa
on this child's body I see those all marks

14 Thirty-two marks adorn a great personality, and I see every one of them on this child's body.

The thirty-two marks of a mahāpuruṣa. So in the Sāmudrika, third verse —

পঞ্চদীর্ঘঃ পঞ্চসূক্ষ্মঃ সপ্তরক্তঃ ষড়ুন্নতঃ ।
ত্রিহ্রস্ব-পৃথু-গম্ভীরো দ্বাত্রিংশল্লক্ষণো মহান্ ॥ ১৫ ॥

pañca-dīrghaḥ pañca-sūkṣmaḥ
five long five fine
sapta-raktaḥ ṣaḍ-unnataḥ
seven red six raised
tri-hrasva-pṛthu-gambhīro
three short, broad, deep
dvātriṁśal-lakṣaṇo mahān
thirty-two-marked great

15 "A great personality bears thirty-two marks: five parts of his body are long, five fine, seven reddish and six raised; three are short, three broad and three deep." (Sāmudrika, 3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The nose, arms, jaws, eyes and knees — these five are long; the skin, hair, finger joints, teeth and body hair — these five are fine; the eyes, soles, palms, palate, lower lip, upper lip and nails — these seven are red; the chest, shoulders, nails, nose, waist and face — these six are raised; the neck, shanks and generative organ — these three are short; the waist, forehead and chest — these three are broad; the navel, voice and strength of character (*sattva*) — these three are deep. One who has these thirty-two marks is a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great personality.

Anubhāṣya.

pañca-dīrghaḥ (one whose five — nose, arms, jaws, eyes and knees — are long), **pañca-sūkṣmaḥ** (whose five — skin, hair, finger joints, teeth and body hair — are fine), **sapta-raktaḥ** (whose seven — the corners of the eyes, soles, palms, palate, lower lip, upper lip and nails — are red, red in colour), **ṣaḍ-unnataḥ** (whose six — chest, shoulders, nails, nose, waist and face — are raised, high), **tri-hrasva-pṛthu-gambhīraḥ** (whose three — neck, shanks and generative organ — are short, small; three — waist, forehead and chest — are broad, wide; three — navel, voice and strength of character — are deep), **dvātriṁśal-lakṣaṇaḥ** (a person who has these thirty-two marks) — **mahān** (a great personality, a *mahāpuruṣa*).

Cakravartī describes the child's greatness and foretells His future —

নারায়ণের চিহ্নযুক্ত শ্রীহস্ত-চরণ ।
এই শিশু সর্ব্ব লোকে করিবে তারণ ॥ ১৬ ॥

nārāyaṇera cihna-yukta śrī-hasta-caraṇa
of Nārāyaṇa bearing the marks His holy hands and feet
ei śiśu sarva loke karibe tāraṇa
this child all people will deliver

16 His hands and feet bear the marks of Nārāyaṇa. This child will deliver all people.

এই ত' করিবে বৈষ্ণব-ধর্ম্মের প্রচার ।
ইহা হৈতে হবে দুই কুলের নিস্তার ॥ ১৭ ॥

ei ta' karibe vaiṣṇava-dharmera pracāra
this one indeed will make of Vaiṣṇava dharma the spreading
ihā haite habe dui kulera nistāra
from Him will be of the two families the deliverance

17 He will spread the Vaiṣṇava dharma far and wide, and through Him both His families will be delivered.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Both families": the father's family and the mother's family.

The name-giving and the festival —

মহোৎসব কর, সব বোলাহ ব্রাহ্মণ ।
আজি দিন ভাল, — করিব নাম-করণ ॥ ১৮ ॥

mahotsava kara, saba bolāha brāhmaṇa
a great festival hold, all call the brāhmaṇas
āji dina bhāla, — kariba nāma-karaṇa
today the day is good — I shall perform the naming

18 Hold a great festival and invite all the brāhmaṇas. Today is an auspicious day; I shall perform the naming ceremony.

The name "Viśvambhara" —

সর্ব্বলোকে করিবে এই ধারণ, পোষণ ।
'বিশ্বম্ভর' নাম ইহার, — এই ত' কারণ ॥ ১৯ ॥

sarva-loke karibe ei dhāraṇa, poṣaṇa
all people will this one uphold, nourish
'viśvambhara' nāma ihāra, — ei ta' kāraṇa
'Viśvambhara' the name His — this indeed the reason

19 He will uphold and nourish all people, and that is why His name is Viśvambhara."

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “With His birth the world came to well-being — just as, long ago, Nārāyaṇa upheld the earth. Therefore His name is ‘Śrī Viśvambhara.’”

“Viśvambhara”: the *Atharva-veda-saṁhitā*, *kāṇḍa* 2, *anuvāka* 3, *prapāṭhaka* 3, mantra 16, number 5: “O Viśvambhara, protect me with all Your sustaining support. *Svāhā*!”

শুনি’ শচী-মিশ্রের মনে আনন্দ বাড়িল ।
ব্রাহ্মণ-ব্রাহ্মণী আনি’ মহোৎসব কৈল ॥ ২০ ॥

śuni’ śacī-miśrera mane ānanda bāḍila
hearing of Śacī and Miśra in the minds joy grew
brāhmaṇa-brāhmaṇī āni’ mahotsava kaila
brāhmaṇas and their wives bringing a great festival they held

20 Hearing this, Śacī and Miśra rejoiced all the more. They invited the brāhmaṇas and their wives and held a great festival.

He displays superhuman deeds —

তবে কত দিনে প্রভুর জানু-চংক্রমণ ।
নানা চমৎকার তথা করাইল দর্শন ॥ ২১ ॥

tabe kata dine prabhura jānu-caṁkramaṇa
then some days later the Lord’s on the knees moving
nānā camatkāra tathā karāila darśana
various wonders there He made to be seen

21 Some days later the Lord began to crawl on His knees, and He showed many wonders.

Anubhāṣya.

Jānu-caṅkramaṇa: crawling on the knees. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “The Lord crawls on His knees — nothing could be more beautiful; little bells jingle at His waist — so charming! One day a snake was moving about the house, and in His childhood play the Lord caught the snake. The snake coiled itself around Him, and the Ṭhākura lay down on top of the snake. Then the snake left the Lord and slithered away.”

The name of Hari stops His crying —

ক্রন্দনের ছলে বলাইল হরিনাম ।
নারী সব ‘হরি’ বলে, — হাসে গৌরধাম ॥ ২২ ॥

krandanera chale balāila hari-nāma
of crying on the pretext He made say the name of Hari
nārī saba ‘hari’ bale, — hāse gaura-dhāma
the women all ‘Hari’ say — laughs the golden One

22 On the pretext of crying He made everyone chant the name of Hari: all the women would call out “Hari!”, and the golden Lord would laugh.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “The lotus-eyed Lord cries only until He hears the name of Hari; then He at once falls quiet. Everyone understood this great sign: whenever He cries, they all chant the name of Hari. As soon as the Lord cries, the women clap their hands and sing *hari-saṅkīrtana*. The name of Hari is constantly on everyone’s lips: on this pretext the Lord makes them chant it, for such is His will.”

Play with the children —

তবে কত দিনে কৈল পদ-চংক্রমণ ।
শিশুগণে মিলি’ কৈল বিবিধ খেলন ॥ ২৩ ॥

tabe kata dine kaila pada-caṅkramaṇa
then some days later He did on the feet walking
śiśu-gaṇe mili’ kaila vividha khelana
with the children joining He did various games

23 Later still He began to walk, and He played all sorts of games with the other children.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “In this way, day by day, Śrī Śacīnandana, the Lord, began to walk about the courtyard on His feet.”

একদিন শচী খই-সন্দেশ আনিয়া ।
বাটা ভরি' দিয়া বলে — খাও ত' বসিয়া ॥ ২৪ ॥

ekadina śacī khai-sandeśa āniyā
one day Śacī puffed rice and sweets bringing
bāṭā bhari' diyā bale — khāo ta' basiyā
a dish filling giving says — eat now sitting down

24 One day Śacī brought puffed rice and sweets, filled a dish, and gave it to Him, saying, "Sit down and eat."

Anubhāṣya.
Bāṭā: a vessel or stand for keeping food or betel; a dish.

Nimāi eats earth —

এত বলি' গেলা শচী গৃহে কর্ম্ম করিতে ।
লুকাঞা লাগিলা শিশু মৃত্তিকা খাইতে ॥ ২৫ ॥

eta bali' gelā śacī gṛhe karma karite
so saying went Śacī into the house work to do
lukāñā lāgilā śiśu mṛttikā khāite
hiding began the child earth to eat

25 With that, Śacī went into the house to do her work, and the child began to eat earth on the sly.

Anubhāṣya.
This incident is among those left out of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* and supplied here, as Ādi 13.49 explains.

Śacī asks the reason —

দেখি' শচী ধাঞা আইলা করি' 'হায়' 'হায়' ।
মাটি কাড়ি' লঞা বলে মাটি কেনে খায় ॥ ২৬ ॥

dekhi' śacī dhāñā āilā kari' 'hāya' 'hāya'
seeing Śacī running came crying 'alas!' 'alas!'
māṭi kāḍi' lañā bale māṭi kene khāya
the earth snatching taking says earth why He eats

26 When Śacī saw it, she came running and cried out, "Oh dear, oh dear!" She snatched the earth away and said, "Why are You eating earth?"

Nimāi's philosophical answer —

কান্দিয়া বলেন শিশু — কেনে কর রোষ ।
তুমি মাটি খাইতে দিলে মোর কিবা দোষ ॥ ২৭ ॥

kāndiyā balena śiśu — kene kara roṣa
weeping says the child — why you make anger
tumi māṭi khāite dile mora kibā doṣa
you earth to eat gave, My what fault

27 The child wept and said, "Why are you angry? You gave Me earth to eat — how is that My fault?

Everything is a transformation of earth —

খই-সন্দেশ-অন্ন, যতেক — মাটির বিকার ।
ইহ মাটি, সেহ মাটি, কি ভেদ-বিচার ॥ ২৮ ॥

khai-sandeśa-anna, yateka — māṭira vikāra
puffed rice, sweets, food, all that — of earth transformations
iha māṭi, seha māṭi, ki bheda-vicāra
this earth, that earth, what of difference consideration

28 Puffed rice, sweets and all food are only earth in another form. This is earth and that is earth; why make any distinction?

মাটি — দেহ, মাটি — ভক্ষ্য, দেখহ বিচারি' ।
অবিচারে দেহ দোষ, কি বলিতে পারি ॥ ২৯ ॥

māṭi — deha, māṭi — bhakṣya, dekhaha vicāri'
earth — the body, earth — food, look considering
avicāre deha doṣa, ki balite pāri
without consideration you give blame, what to say can I

29 The body is earth, and food is earth — think it over and see. You blame Me without thinking; what can I say?"

Śacī's reply —

অন্তরে বিস্মিত শচী বলিল তাহারে ।
মাটি খাইতে জ্ঞানযোগ কে শিখাল তোরে ॥ ৩০ ॥

antare vismita śacī balila tāhāre
inwardly astonished Śacī said to Him
māṭi khāite jñāna-yoga ke śikhāla tore
earth for eating this jñāna-yoga who taught You

30 Inwardly astonished, Śacī said to Him, "Who taught You such *jñāna-yoga*, just so You could eat earth?

The difference between a substance and its transformation, or what distinguishes the favourable from the unfavorable —

মাটির বিকার অন্ন খাইলে দেহ-পুষ্টি হয় ।
মাটি খাইলে রোগ হয়, দেহ যায় ক্ষয় ॥ ৩১ ॥

māṭira vikāra anna khāile deha-puṣṭi haya
of earth the transformation food if eaten of the body nourishment is
māṭi khāile roga haya, deha yāya kṣaya
earth if eaten disease comes, the body goes to decay

31 Food is earth transformed, and when we eat it, it nourishes the body. But eat earth itself, and disease sets in and the body wastes away.

মাটির বিকার ঘটে পানি ভরি' আনি ।
মাটি-পিণ্ডে ধরি যবে, শোষি' যায় পানি ॥ ৩২ ॥

māṭira vikāra ghaṭe pāni bhari' āni
of earth the transformation in a pot water filling I bring
māṭi-piṇḍe dhari yabe, śoṣi' yāya pāni
in a lump of earth I hold when, soaking goes the water

32 In a pot, which is earth transformed, I fetch water; but try to hold it in a lump of earth, and the water soaks away."

Hearing this, the Lord speaks —

আত্ম লুকাইতে প্রভু বলিলা তাঁহারে ।
আগে কেন ইহা মাতা না শিখালে মোরে ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ātma lukāite prabhu balilā tāṁhāre
Himself to hide the Lord said to her
āge kena ihā mātā nā śikhāle more
before why this mother not taught Me

33 To keep Himself hidden, the Lord said to her, "Mother, why did you not teach Me this before?

Anubhāṣya.
To take objects of food for oneself is merely an activity of the material kind; there is no service to Hari in it. The *nirviśeṣa-vādīs* mistakenly regard things favourable to Kṛṣṇa's service as being of the same nature as unfavorable things. Such a notion is an utterly mistaken, immature expression of mundane conclusions. Through His mother's mouth, with the simple example of clay and a pot, Mahāprabhu showed how worthless such foolish impersonal thinking is.

এবে সে জানিলাঙ, আর মাটি না খাইব ।
ক্ষুধা লাগে যবে, তবে তোমার স্তন পিব ॥ ৩৪ ॥

ebe se jānilāṅa, āra māṭi nā khāiba
now indeed I know, any more earth not I will eat
kṣudhā lāge yabe, tabe tomāra stana piba
hunger comes when, then your breast I will drink

34 Now that I know, I will not eat earth any more. When I am hungry, I will drink at your breast.”

এত বলি’ জননীর কোলেতে চড়িয়া ।
স্তন পান করে প্রভু ঈষৎ হাসিয়া ॥ ৩৫ ॥

eta bali’ jananīra kolete caḍiyā
so saying of the mother onto the lap climbing
stana pāna kare prabhu īṣat hāsiyā
the breast drinking does the Lord slightly smiling

35 Saying this, the Lord climbed onto His mother’s lap and, with a little smile, began to nurse.

In various ways He manifests pastimes of majesty —

এই মতে নানা-ছলে ঐশ্বর্য্য দেখায় ।
বাল্যভাব প্রকটিয়া পশ্চাৎ লুকায় ॥ ৩৬ ॥

ei mate nānā-chale aiśvarya dekhāya
in this way on various pretexts majesty He shows
bālya-bhāva prakaṭiyā paścāt lukāya
the child’s mood displaying afterwards He hides

36 Thus, on one pretext or another, He would show His majesty, and afterwards, slipping back into the ways of a child, He would hide it again.

He eats the pilgrim brāhmaṇa’s rice and delivers him —

অতিথি-বিপ্রের অন্ন খাইল তিনবার ।
পাছে গুপ্তে সেই বিপ্রে করিল নিস্তার ॥ ৩৭ ॥

atithi-viprera anna khāila tina-bāra
of a guest brāhmaṇa’s food He ate three times
pāche gupte sei vipre karila nistāra
afterwards in secret that brāhmaṇa He made delivered

37 Three times He ate the food a brāhmaṇa guest had cooked, and afterwards, in secret, He delivered him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A pilgrim (*tairthika*) came as a guest to the house of Śrī Jagannātha Miśra, and Miśra gave him all he needed for cooking and had him cook. When the pilgrim brāhmaṇa was offering the food to Gopāla in meditation, Nimāi came and began to eat his rice. Rejecting the food Nimāi had touched, the guest brāhmaṇa cooked once more; but this time too, as he offered it in meditation, the same thing happened. The food was cooked a third time. By then everyone in the house was asleep. The brāhmaṇa was offering the cooked rice to Gopāla in meditation when Nimāi came and began to eat that rice. Struck by fate, the brāhmaṇa began to cry out in distress. Then Nimāi said: "O brāhmaṇa, when I was Yaśodā's darling in Vraja, the same thing happened to you then. Now too, drawn by your devotion, I have mercifully shown Myself to you." Seeing his own worshipful Deity, the brāhmaṇa was enchanted with great prema; he counted himself blessed and honoured the remaining prasāda. The Lord forbade him to reveal this hidden pastime.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 3.

He bewilders the thief —

চোরে লঞা গেল প্রভুকে বাহিরে পাইয়া ।
তার স্কন্ধে চড়ি' আইলা তারে ভুলাইয়া ॥ ৩৮ ॥

core lañā gela prabhuke bāhire pāiyā
thieves taking went off the Lord outside finding
tāra skandhe caḍi' āilā tāre bhulāiyā
on their shoulders riding He came back them bewildering

38 Another time some thieves found the Lord outside and carried Him off; but He bewildered them and came home riding on their shoulders.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In His very early childhood Mahāprabhu, decked with gold ornaments, was playing outside the gate of the house. Two thieves put Him on their shoulders and carried Him off, as if to treat Him to sweets. The thieves thought: "We'll take the boy into the forest, kill him and take all his ornaments." Spreading His māyā, Mahāprabhu

made them lose their way, and riding on their shoulders He came back to the gate of His own house. His relatives were running everywhere searching for Him; the thieves set the child down right in front of them and fled. With great care the child was carried into Śacī's courtyard.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 3.

On Ekādaśī He eats Viṣṇu's naivedya from the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa

—

ব্যাধি-ছলে জগদীশ-হিরণ্য-সদনে ।
বিষ্ণু-নৈবেদ্য খাইল একাদশী-দিনে ॥ ৩৯ ॥

vyādhi-chale jagadīśa-hiraṇya-sadane
of illness on the pretext of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya in the house
viṣṇu-naivedya khāila ekādaśī-dine
Viṣṇu's offering He ate on Ekādaśī day

39 On the day of Ekādaśī, pretending to be ill, He ate the food offered to Viṣṇu in the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
At the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya Paṇḍita an offering (*naivedya*) for Viṣṇu was being prepared on the day of Ekādaśī. Mahāprabhu wanted to eat that *naivedya*, and He sent His father to the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa. When Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa heard the boy's request, they were quite astonished and said: "Today is Ekādaśī, and in our house the *naivedya* for Viṣṇu is being prepared. How did such a small child know this? Surely there is some potency of Viṣṇu (*vaiṣṇavī śakti*) in Him." And they sent Him the *naivedya* to eat. Mahāprabhu had obtained the *naivedya* on this pretext: "My body is ill; if I eat Viṣṇu's *naivedya*, the illness will be cured." He fed the *naivedya* that was brought to the boys and ate some Himself, and so His illness was cured. The house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa stood some way from the house of Jagannātha Miśra, about one *krośa* to the southeast. For a child it is impossible to know what is happening so far away.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 4.

Pastimes befitting a child: stealing, quarrels and so on —

শিশুগণ লয়ে পাড়া-পড়সীর ঘরে ।
চুরি করি' দ্রব্য খায়, মারে বালকেরে ॥ ৪০ ॥

śiśugaṇa laye pāḍā-paḍasīra ghare
the children taking of the neighbours into the houses
curi kari' dravya khāya, māre bālakere
stealing things He eats, beats the boys

40 He would take the children into the neighbours' houses and steal food to eat, and He would beat the other boys.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): "However many friends and relatives live nearby — in their houses He Himself steals every day for fun. In one house He drinks milk, in another He eats rice. Where He finds nothing, He breaks the pots. If there is a child in the house, He makes him cry." Ibid., Chapter 4: "Someone says: 'My son is very small, and He poured water into his ears — now he cries without end.'"

The complaints to Śacī and Śacī's scolding —

শিশু সব শচী-স্থানে কৈল নিবেদন ।
শুনি' শচী পুত্রে কিছু দিলা ওলাহন ॥ ৪১ ॥

śiśu saba śacī-sthāne kaila nivedana
the children all in Śacī's presence made complaint
śuni' śacī putre kichu dilā olāhana
hearing Śacī her son a little gave a scolding

41 The children all complained to Śacī, and when she heard them, she scolded her son a little:

Anubhāṣya.

Olāhana: a reproach, a scolding.

কেনে চুরি কর, কেনে মারহ শিশুরে ।
কেনে পর-ঘরে যাহ, কি বা নাহি ঘরে ॥ ৪২ ॥

kene curi kara, kene māraha śiśure
why stealing You do, why You beat the children
kene para-ghare yāha, ki vā nāhi ghare
why to others' houses You go, what or is not at home

42 "Why do You steal? Why do You beat the other children? Why do You go into other people's houses? What do You lack at home?"

The Lord's anger and His rampage at home —

শুনি' ক্রুদ্ধ হঞা প্রভু ঘর-ভিতর যাঞা ।
ঘরে যত ভাণ্ড ছিল, ফেলিল ভাঙ্গিয়া ॥ ৪৩ ॥

śuni' kruddha hañā prabhu ghara-bhitara yāñā
hearing angry becoming the Lord inside the house going
ghare yata bhāṇḍa chila, phelila bhāṅgiyā
in the house all the pots there were, He threw down breaking

43 Hearing this, the Lord grew angry, went into the house, and smashed every pot in it.

The Lord is consoled, and He feels ashamed —

তবে শচী কোলে করি' করাইল সন্তোষ ।
লজ্জিত হইলা প্রভু জানি' নিজ দোষ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

tabe śacī kole kari' karāila santoṣa
then Śacī on her lap taking made content
lajjita hailā prabhu jāni' nija doṣa
ashamed became the Lord knowing His own fault

44 Then Śacī took Him on her lap and comforted Him, and the Lord, knowing He was at fault, felt ashamed.

He strikes His mother and, seeing her faint, brings rare coconuts —

কভু মৃদুহস্তে কৈল মাতাকে তাড়ন ।
মাতাকে মূর্চ্ছিতা দেখি, করয়ে ক্রন্দন ॥ ৪৫ ॥

kabhu mṛdu-haste kaila mātāke tāḍana
once with soft hands He did His mother striking
mātāke mūrcchitā dekhi, karaye krandana
His mother fainted seeing, begins crying

45 Once He struck His mother with His soft little hands, and when He saw her faint, He began to cry.

নারীগণ কহে, — নারিকেল দেহ আনি' ।
তবে সুস্থ হইবেন তোমার জননী ॥ ৪৬ ॥

nārīgaṇa kahe, — nārikela deha āni'
the women say — a coconut give bringing
tabe sustha haibena tomāra jananī
then well will be Your mother

46 The women said, "Bring her a coconut, and then Your mother will recover."

Anubhāṣya.
Locana dāsa's *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala* (Ādi): "Then a divine woman smiled, took Viśvambhara by the chin and said: 'Bring your mother two coconuts — then Śacī, your mother, will revive.' Hearing this, Viśvambhara was delighted and at once brought a pair of coconuts."

বাহিরে যাঞা আনিলেন দুই নারিকেল ।
দেখিয়া অপূর্ব্ব হৈলা বিস্মিত সকল ॥ ৪৭ ॥

bāhire yāñā ānilena dui nārikela
outside going He brought two coconuts
dekhiyā apūrva hailā vismita sakala
seeing the marvel became astonished all

47 He went out and brought back two coconuts, and everyone was astonished at the marvel.

Fun with the girls at bathing time —

কভু শিশু-সঙ্গে স্নান করিল গঙ্গাতে ।
কন্যাগণ আইলা তাঁহা দেবতা পূজিতে ॥ ৪৮ ॥

kabhu śiśu-saṅge snāna karila gaṅgāte
sometimes with the children bath He took in the Gaṅgā
kanyāgaṇa āilā tāṁhā devatā pūjite
the girls came there the gods to worship

48 Sometimes He bathed in the Gaṅgā with the other children, and the girls would come there to worship the gods.

গঙ্গাস্নান করি' পূজা করিতে লাগিলা ।
কন্যাগণ-মধ্যে প্রভু আসিয়া বসিলা ॥ ৪৯ ॥

gaṅgā-snāna kari' pūjā karite lāgilā
bath in the Gaṅgā having taken worship to do they began
kanyāgaṇa-madhye prabhu āsiyā basilā
of the girls in the midst the Lord coming sat down

49 When they had bathed in the Gaṅgā and begun their worship, the Lord would come and sit down among them.

The Lord's words to the girls —

কন্যারে কহে, — আমা পূজ, আমি দিব বর ।
গঙ্গা-দুর্গা — দাসী মোর, মহেশ — কিঙ্কর ॥ ৫০ ॥

kanyāre kahe, — āmā pūja, āmi diba vara
to the girls He says — Me worship, I will give a boon
gaṅgā-durgā — dāsī mora, maheśa — kiṅkara
Gaṅgā and Durgā — maidservants Mine, Maheśa — servant

50 He would say to the girls, “Worship Me, and I will grant you a boon. Gaṅgā and Durgā are My maidservants, and Maheśa is My servant.”[1]

আপনি চন্দন পরি’ পরেন ফুলমালা ।
নৈবেদ্য কাড়িয়া খা’ন — সন্দেশ, চাল, কলা ॥ ৫১ ॥

āpani candana pari’ parena phula-mālā
Himself sandal paste putting on He puts on flower garlands
naivedya kāḍiyā khā’na — sandeśa, cāla, kalā
the offerings snatching He eats — sweets, rice, bananas

51 He would smear Himself with sandal paste and put on the flower garlands, then snatch the offerings and eat them — sweets, rice and bananas.

The girls’ reply —

ক্রোধে কন্যাগণ কহে — শুন, হে নিমাঞি ।
গ্রাম-সম্বন্ধে হও তুমি আমা-সবার ভাই ॥ ৫২ ॥

krodhe kanyāgaṇa kahe — śuna, he nimāñi
in anger the girls say — listen, O Nimāi
grāma-sambandhe hao tumi āmā-sabāra bhāi
by village ties are You of us all the brother

52 The girls said angrily, “Listen, Nimāi! By village ties You are a brother to us all.

আমা-সবার পক্ষে ইহা কহিতে না যুয়ায় ।
না লহ দেবতা-সজ্জ, না কর অন্যায় ॥ ৫৩ ॥

āmā-sabāra pakṣe ihā kahite nā yuyāya
of us all on the part this to say not it is fitting
nā laha devatā-sajja, nā kara anyāya
do not take the gods’ offerings, do not do wrong

53 It is not proper for us to say this to You, but do not take the gods’ offerings, and do not misbehave!”

The Lord gives blessings in jest —

প্রভু কহে, — তোমা-সবাকে দিলাঙ এই বর ।
তোমা-সবার ভর্ত্তা হবে পরম সুন্দর ॥ ৫৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tomā-sabāke dilāṅa ei vara
the Lord says — to you all I give this boon
tomā-sabāra bhartā habe parama sundara
of you all the husband will be supremely handsome

54 The Lord said, "I give you all this boon: each of you will have a most handsome husband.

পণ্ডিত, বিদগ্ধ, যুবা, ধনধান্যবান্ ।
সাত সাত পুত্র হবে — চিরায়ু, মতিমান্ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

paṇḍita, vidagdha, yuvā, dhana-dhānyavān
learned, refined, young, rich in wealth and grain
sāta sāta putra habe — cirāyu, matimān
seven seven sons there will be — long-lived, wise

55 He will be learned and refined, young and rich in wealth and grain, and each of you will have seven sons, long-lived and wise."

বর শুনি' কন্যাগণের অন্তরে সন্তোষ ।
বাহিরে ভর্ৎসন করে করি' মিথ্যা রোষ ॥ ৫৬ ॥

vara śuni' kanyā-gaṇera antare santoṣa
the boon hearing of the girls in the hearts delight
bāhire bhartsana kare kari' mithyā roṣa
outwardly scolding they do making false anger

56 Hearing this boon, the girls were delighted at heart, but outwardly they scolded Him with feigned anger.

Feigned anger, in the guise of a curse, at a girl who ran away —

কোন কন্যা পলাইল নৈবেদ্য লইয়া ।
তারে ডাকি' কহে প্রভু সক্রোধ হইয়া ॥ ৫৭ ॥

kona kanyā palāila naivedya laiyā
some girl ran away the offering taking
tāre ḍāki' kahe prabhu sakrodha haiyā
her calling says the Lord angry becoming

57 If some girl ran off with her offering, the Lord would call after her angrily:

যদি নৈবেদ্য না দেহ হইয়া কৃপণী ।
বুড়া ভর্ত্তা হবে, আর চারি সতিনী ॥ ৫৮ ॥

yadi naivedya nā deha haiyā kṛpaṇī
if the offering not you give being miserly
buḍā bhartā habe, āra cāri satinī
old husband will be, and four co-wives

58 "If you are stingy and will not give Me your offering, you will get an old husband — and four co-wives!"

Frightened, the girls give their offerings —

ইহা শুনি' তা-সবার মনে হৈল ভয় ।
কোন কিছু জানে, কিবা দেবাবিষ্ট হয় ॥ ৫৯ ॥

ihā śuni' tā-sabāra mane haila bhaya
this hearing of them all in the minds arose fear
kona kichu jāne, kibā devāviṣṭa haya
something some He knows, or by a god possessed He is

59 The girls grew frightened at these words: "Perhaps He knows something, or perhaps some god has entered Him."

আনিয়া নৈবেদ্য তারা সম্মুখে ধরিল ।
খাইয়া নৈবেদ্য তারে ইষ্টবর দিল ॥ ৬০ ॥

āniyā naivedya tārā sammukhe dharila
bringing the offering they before Him held
khāiyā naivedya tāre iṣṭavara dila
eating the offering to them the desired boon He gave

60 So they brought their offerings and held them out before Him, and when He had eaten, He gave them the boon they longed for.

The Lord's sweet mischief delights everyone —

এইমত চাপল্য সব লোকেরে দেখায় ।
দুঃখ কারো মনে নহে, সবে সুখ পায় ॥ ৬১ ॥

ei mata cāpalya saba lokere dekhāya
in this way naughtiness to all people He shows
duḥkha kāro mane nahe, sabe sukha pāya
sorrow anyone's in the mind is not, all happiness get

61 In this way He showed His mischief to everyone, yet no one was ever unhappy; it brought them all joy.

The meeting with Lakṣmī-devī, Vallabha's daughter —

একদিন বল্লভাচার্য্য-কন্যা 'লক্ষ্মী' নাম ।
দেবতা পূজিতে আইল করি' গঙ্গাস্নান ॥ ৬২ ॥

ekadina vallabhācārya-kanyā 'lakṣmī' nāma
one day Vallabhācārya's daughter 'Lakṣmī' by name
devatā pūjite āila kari' gaṅgā-snāna
the gods to worship came having taken a bath in the Gaṅgā

62 One day Vallabhācārya's daughter, Lakṣmī by name, bathed in the Gaṅgā and came to worship the gods.

Both rejoice on seeing each other —

তাঁরে দেখি’ প্রভুর হৈল সাভিলাষ মন ।
লক্ষ্মী চিত্তে সুখ পাইল প্রভুর দর্শন ॥ ৬৩ ॥

tāṁre dekhi’ prabhura haila sābhilāṣa mana
her seeing the Lord’s became longing mind
lakṣmī citte sukha pāila prabhura darśana
Lakṣmī in her heart joy felt the Lord’s at the sight

63 When the Lord saw her, His heart was drawn to her; and at the sight of the Lord, Lakṣmī felt joy within.

The eternally perfect, natural love of the two and their joy —

সাহজিক প্রীতি দুঁহার করিল উদয় ।
বাল্যভাবে ছন্ন তনু হইল নিশ্চয় ॥ ৬৪ ॥

sāhajika prīti duṁhāra karila udaya
natural love of both made arising
bālya-bhāve channa tanu haila niścaya
in the childhood mood hidden the form became certainly

64 A natural love awoke in them both, though the mood of childhood still veiled its true form.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Lakṣmī is Bhagavān’s eternal consort, and Bhagavān is Lakṣmī’s eternal husband. Therefore the eternal love between Them is *sāhajika*, inborn. That love appeared concealed beneath a childlike mood.

দুঁহা দেখি’ দুঁহার চিত্তে হইল উল্লাস ।
দেবপূজা-ছলে কৈল দুঁহে পরকাশ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

duṁhā dekhi’ duṁhāra citte haila ullāsa
each other seeing of both in the hearts arose delight
deva-pūjā-chale kaila duṁhe parakāśa
of worshipping the gods on the pretext did both revealing

65 Seeing each other, both rejoiced at heart, and on the pretext of worshipping the gods they let their feelings show.

The Lord tells Lakṣmī to worship Him —

প্রভু কহে, — 'আমা' পূজ, আমি — মহেশ্বর ।
আমারে পূজিলে পাবে অভীপ্সিত বর ॥ ৬৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — 'āmā' pūja, āmi — maheśvara
the Lord says — Me worship, I — the Supreme Lord
āmāre pūjile pābe abhīpsita vara
Me worshipping you will get the desired boon

66 The Lord said, "Worship Me, for I am Maheśvara, the Supreme Lord. If you worship Me, you will receive the boon you desire."

Lakṣmī carries out the order —

লক্ষ্মী তাঁর অঙ্গে দিল স-পুষ্প চন্দন ।
মল্লিকার মালা দিয়া করিল বন্দন ॥ ৬৭ ॥

lakṣmī tāṁra aṅge dila sa-puṣpa candana
Lakṣmī His on the body placed with flowers sandal paste
mallikāra mālā diyā karila vandana
of mallikā a garland giving she made obeisance

67 Lakṣmī placed sandal paste and flowers on His body, offered Him a garland of mallikā jasmine, and bowed to Him.

The Lord is pleased —

প্রভু তাঁর পূজা পাঞা হাসিতে লাগিল ।
শ্লোক পড়ি' তাঁর ভাব অঙ্গীকার কৈল ॥ ৬৮ ॥

prabhu tāṁra pūjā pāñā hāsite lāgila
the Lord her worship receiving to smile began
śloka paḍi' tāṁra bhāva aṅgīkāra kaila
a verse reciting her feeling He accepted

68 Receiving her worship, the Lord began to smile, and by reciting a verse He accepted the sentiment of her heart.

Anubhāṣya.

Vallabhācārya was a royal paṇḍita (*rāja-paṇḍita*) living in Navadvīpa. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (44): "He who formerly was the great King Janaka, lord of Mithilā, is now Vallabhācārya; he is also considered to be Bhīṣmaka." Śrī Gaurahari first accepted the hand of his daughter, Lakṣmīpriyā Devī.

Lakṣmī-devī: *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (45): "Śrī Jānakī and Rukmiṇī are his daughter named Lakṣmī. She, named Lakṣmī, is described in the *Caitanya-carita* thus: 'Vallabhācārya's daughter Lakṣmī, who had descended together with Him, was going with her friends to bathe in the river of the gods, and there she came before the Lord's eyes.'"

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 22, verse 25)

সঙ্কল্পো বিদিতঃ সাধ্ব্যো ভবতীনাং মদর্চ্চনম্ ।
ময়ানুমোদিতঃ সোঽসৌ সত্যো ভবিতুমর্হতি ॥ ৬৯ ॥

saṅkalpo viditaḥ sādhvyo
the resolve is known O chaste ones
bhavatīnāṁ mad-arcanam
your worship of Me
mayānumoditaḥ so 'sau
by Me approved that very
satyo bhavitum arhati
true to become deserves

69 "O chaste ones, I know your resolve to worship Me. I accept it, and it deserves to come true." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.25)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O chaste maidens, I have understood why you worship, and this gives Me special joy. Your intention is indeed worthy of fulfilment.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words. The gopīs, who desired Kṛṣṇa, were keeping the Kātyāyanī vow; He stole their clothes, then gave them back, and seeing their desire to attain

Kṛṣṇa, He said:

sādhvyaḥ (O chaste ones)! **mad-arcanam** (worship for the sake of attaining Me — just this) **bhavatīnām** (your, the *gopīs'*) **saṅkalpaḥ** (desire, that is, the feeling in your hearts — though out of shyness you did not speak of it) **mayā viditaḥ** (is known to Me) **anumoditaḥ** (and accepted); (therefore) **saḥ asau** (that desire) **satyaḥ** (true, fulfilled) **bhavitum arhati** (deserves to become).

এইমত লীলা দুঁহে করি' গেলা ঘরে ।
গম্ভীর চৈতন্য-লীলা কে বুঝিতে পারে ॥ ৭০ ॥

ei-mata līlā duṁhe kari' gelā ghare
in this way pastime the two having played went home
gambhīra caitanya-līlā ke bujhite pāre
deep Caitanya's pastimes who to understand is able

70 After this pastime the two of them went home. Who can fathom the deep pastimes of Caitanya?

Seeing the Lord's mischief, everyone complains —

চৈতন্য চাপল্য দেখি' প্রেমে সর্ব্ব জন ।
শচী-জগন্নাথে দেখি' দেন ওলাহন ॥ ৭১ ॥

caitanya cāpalya dekhi' preme sarva jana
Caitanya's naughtiness seeing out of love all people
śacī-jagannāthe dekhi' dena olāhana
Śacī and Jagannātha meeting give complaints

71 Seeing Caitanya's mischief, everyone, out of love for Him, would come to Śacī and Jagannātha with complaints.

Śacī tries to catch Nimāi —

একদিন শচী-দেবী পুত্রেরে ভর্ৎসিয়া ।
ধরিবারে গেলা পুত্রে, গেলা পলাইয়া ॥ ৭২ ॥

ekadina śacī-devī putrere bhartsiyā
one day Śacī-devī her son having scolded
dharibāre gelā putra, gelā palāiyā
to catch went her son, He went running away

72 One day Śacī-devī scolded her son and went to catch Him, but He ran away.

Nimāi sits on the discarded pots —

উচ্ছিষ্ট-গর্ত্তে ত্যক্ত-হাণ্ডীর উপর ।
বসিয়াছেন সুখে প্রভু দেব-বিশ্বম্ভর ॥ ৭৩ ॥

ucchiṣṭa-garte tyakta-hāṇḍīra upara
in the refuse pit of the discarded pots on top
basiyāchena sukhe prabhu deva-viśvambhara
is seated happily the Lord divine Viśvambhara

73 Then the Lord Viśvambhara, upholder of the universe, sat down contentedly on the cast-off pots in the refuse pit.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 7): "The Lord made all the discarded pots from Viṣṇu's *naivedya* His seat and sat on them. His mother came, saw this and cried: 'Alas, alas! It isn't right, my son, to sit in such a place!' The Lord said: 'Everywhere My knowledge is nondual. In these pots there is, at root, no defilement. Pots in which food is cooked for Viṣṇu are never defiled; touching such pots purifies other places too.'"

Thinking her son defiled, Śacī wants to purify Him —

শচী আসি' কহে, — কেনে অশুচি ছুঁইলা ।
গঙ্গাস্নান কর যাই' — অপবিত্র হইলা ॥ ৭৪ ॥

śacī āsi' kahe, — kene aśuci chum̐ilā
Śacī coming says — why the impure You touched
gaṅgā-snāna kara yāi' — apavitra hailā
bath in the Gaṅgā take going — unclean You have become

74 Śacī came and said, “Why have You touched these unclean things? Go and bathe in the Gaṅgā — You have made Yourself impure.”

The son instructs His mother in the knowledge of Brahman —

ইহা শুনি’ মাতাকে কহিল ব্রহ্মজ্ঞান ।
বিস্মিতা হইয়া মাতা করাইল স্নান ॥ ৭৫ ॥

ihā śuni’ mātāke kahila brahma-jñāna
this hearing to His mother He spoke knowledge of Brahman
vismitā haiyā mātā karāila snāna
astonished becoming the mother made Him bathe

75 In reply He spoke to His mother of *brahma-jñāna*, spiritual knowledge. She was astonished, but still she made Him bathe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lord said: “Mother, ‘defiled by remnants’ and ‘undefiled’ are merely human notions; in reality there is not a grain of truth in them. In these pots you cooked food for Viṣṇu and offered it to Viṣṇu, so these pots can never be defiled. The soul is an eternally pure reality: what have considerations of defilement and the like to do with it?” Hearing this knowledge of Brahman, His mother was amazed and had Him bathe.

Thus ends the fourteenth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

At bedtime Śacī sees the gods —

কভু পুত্রসঙ্গে শচী করিলা শয়ন ।
দেখে, দিব্যলোক আসি’ ভরিল ভবন ॥ ৭৬ ॥

kabhu putrasaṅge śacī karilā śayana
once with her son Śacī lay down to rest
dekhe, divyaloka āsi’ bharila bhavana
she sees divine beings coming filled the house

76 Once, as Śacī lay resting with her son, she saw that divine beings had come and filled the house.

শচী বলে, — যাহ, পুত্র, বোলাহ বাপেরে ।
মাতৃ-আজ্ঞা পাইয়া প্রভু চলিলা বাহিরে ॥ ৭৭ ॥

śacī bale, — yāha, putra, bolāha bāpere
Śacī says — go, son, call Your father
māṭṛ-ājñā pāiyā prabhu calilā bāhire
the mother's order receiving the Lord went outside

77 Śacī said, "Go, my son, and call Your father." At His mother's bidding the Lord went outside.

As He goes at His mother's word, ankle bells ring though He wears none —

চলিতে চরণে নূপুর বাজে ঝন্‌ঝন্ ।
শুনি' চমকিত হৈল পিতামাতার মন ॥ ৭৮ ॥

calite caraṇe nūpura bāje jhanjhan
as He walked on the feet anklets ring jhan-jhan
śuni' camakita haila pitāmātāra mana
hearing startled became of father and mother the minds

78 As He walked, anklets jingled on His feet, and His father and mother were startled to hear them.

Miśra's astonishment —

মিশ্র কহে, — এই বড় অদ্ভুত কাহিনী ।
শিশুর শূন্যপদে কেনে নূপুরের ধ্বনি ॥ ৭৯ ॥

miśra kahe, — ei baḍa adbhuta kāhinī
Miśra says — this very wonderful happening
śiśura śūnya-pade kene nūpurera dhvani
of the child on bare feet why of anklets the sound

79 Miśra said, "This is a great wonder! Why do we hear anklets on the child's bare feet?"

Śacī's astonishment at seeing the gods —

শচী কহে, — আর এক অদ্ভুত দেখিল ।
দিব্য দিব্য লোক আসি' অঙ্গন ভরিল ॥ ৮০ ॥

śacī kahe, — āra eka adbhuta dekhila
Śacī says — another one wonder I saw
divya divya loka āsi' aṅgana bharila
divine divine beings coming the courtyard filled

80 Śacī said, "I saw another wonder too: radiant divine beings came and filled the courtyard.

কিবা কোলাহল করে, বুঝিতে না পারি ।
কাহাকে বা স্তুতি করে, অনুমান করি ॥ ৮১ ॥

kibā kolāhala kare, bujhite nā pāri
what clamour they make, to understand not I can
kāhāke vā stuti kare, anumāna kari
whom or praises they offer, a guess I make

81 They raised such a clamour that I could not make out what they said; whom they were praising I can only guess."

Both think of Nimāi's welfare —

মিশ্র বলে, — কিছু হউক, চিন্তা কিছু নাই ।
বিশ্বম্ভরের কুশল হউক, — এই মাত্র চাই ॥ ৮২ ॥

miśra bale, — kichu hauka, cintā kichu nāi
Miśra says — whatever may be, worry any there is not
viśvambharera kuśala hauka, — ei mātra cāi
Viśvambhara's welfare may be — this only I want

82 Miśra said, "Whatever it may be, there is nothing to worry about. All I want is for Viśvambhara to be well."

Seeing the Lord's mischief, Miśra scolds Him severely —

একদিন মিশ্র পুত্রের চাপল্য দেখিয়া ।
ধর্ম্ম-শিক্ষা দিল বহু ভর্ৎসনা করিয়া ॥ ৮৩ ॥

ekadina miśra putrera cāpalya dekhiyā
one day Miśra his son's naughtiness seeing
dharma-śikṣā dila bahu bhartsanā kariyā
instruction in dharma gave much scolding doing

83 One day, seeing his son's mischief, Miśra scolded Him severely and taught Him what dharma requires.

At night a dream: a brāhmaṇa rebukes Miśra —

রাত্রে স্বপ্ন দেখে, — এক আসি' ব্রাহ্মণ ।
মিশ্রেরে কহয়ে কিছু সরোষ বচন ॥ ৮৪ ॥

rātre svapna dekhe, — eka āsi' brāhmaṇa
at night a dream he sees — one coming brāhmaṇa
miśrere kahaye kichu sa-roṣa vacana
to Miśra speaks some angry words

84 At night he dreamt that a brāhmaṇa came and spoke to him angrily:

মিশ্র, তুমি পুত্রের তত্ত্ব কিছুই না জান ।
ভর্ৎসন-তাড়ন কর, — পুত্র করি' মান ॥ ৮৫ ॥

miśra, tumi putrera tattva kichui nā jāna
Miśra, you of your son the truth at all not know
bhartsana-tāḍana kara, — putra kari' māna
scolding and beating you do — a son considering regarding

85 "Miśra, you know nothing of who your son truly is. You scold and beat Him because you think of Him as merely your son."

Miśra's transcendental reply, steeped in affection —

মিশ্র কহে, — দেব, সিদ্ধ, মুনি কেনে নয়।
যে সে বড় হউক, এবে আমার তনয় ॥ ৮৬ ॥

miśra kahe, — deva, siddha, muni kene naya
Miśra says — a god, a perfected one, a sage why not
ye se baḍa hauka, ebe āmāra tanaya
whoever great may He be, now my son

86 Miśra said, "Be He a god, a perfected being or a sage — however great He may be, now He is my son.

পুত্রের লালন-শিক্ষা — পিতার স্বধর্ম্ম।
আমি না শিখালে, কৈছে জানিবে ধর্ম্ম-মর্ম্ম ॥ ৮৭ ॥

putrera lālana-śikṣā — pitāra sva-dharma
of a son the upbringing and teaching — of a father the own dharma
āmi nā śikhāle kaiche jānibe dharma-marma
I not if teach, how will He know of dharma the heart

87 To raise and teach his son is a father's own dharma. If I do not teach Him, how will He come to know the heart of dharma?"

The brāhmaṇa's words and Miśra's reply —

বিপ্র কহে, — এই যদি দৈব-সিদ্ধ হয়।
স্বতঃসিদ্ধজ্ঞান তবে শিক্ষা ব্যর্থ হয় ॥ ৮৮ ॥

vipra kahe, — ei yadi daiva-siddha haya
the brāhmaṇa says — He if divinely perfect is
svataḥ-siddha-jñāna tabe śikṣā vyartha haya
self-perfect knowledge, then teaching useless is

88 The brāhmaṇa said, "If He is divine and perfect by nature, His knowledge is complete in itself, and teaching Him is in vain."

Anubhāṣya.

See Antya 4.174–176. The Lord's words to Uddhava (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.28.4): "What is good and what is bad in duality, which is not reality — and to what extent? Whatever is spoken in words and conceived in the mind is false." That is, "in the transcendental there is no notion of things as good and bad" (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya 4.174). "In duality, every notion of good and bad is a mere product of the mind; 'this is good, this is bad' — all this is error" (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya 4.176). (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.19.45): "To see good and bad qualities is itself the fault; the virtue is to be free of both." And (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.21.3): "O sinless one, purity and impurity, merit and fault, the auspicious and the inauspicious are prescribed even for things of the same kind — to discern the nature of a substance, for the sake of dharma, for worldly dealings and for the maintenance of life."

Miśra regarded his son Nimāi as untaught and ignorant and wished to teach Him and awaken knowledge in Him. Seeing this, the brāhmaṇa said to Miśra: "Your son is an eternally perfect deity. Yet you take His eternally perfect, natural knowledge for such foolishness, and so your attempt to teach Him proves futile. Therefore it does not become you."

মিশ্র কহে, — পুত্র কেনে নহে নারায়ণ ।
তথাপিহ পিতার ধর্ম্ম — পুত্রকে শিক্ষণ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

miśra kahe, — putra kene nahe nārāyaṇa
Miśra says — my son why not be Nārāyaṇa
tathāpiha pitāra dharma — putrake śikṣaṇa
even so a father's dharma — his son's teaching

89 Miśra said, "My son may well be Nārāyaṇa; even so, it is a father's dharma to teach his son."

Miśra's pure parental affection for the Lord —

এইমতে দুঁহে করেন ধর্ম্মের বিচার ।
শুদ্ধবাৎসল্য মিশ্রের, নাহি জানে আর ॥ ৯০ ॥

ei-mate dum̐he karena dharmera vicāra
in this way the two do of dharma discussion
śuddha-vātsalya miśrera, nāhi jāne āra
pure parental love Miśra's, not he knows anything else

90 So the two of them discussed dharma. Miśra's parental love was pure; he knew nothing else.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu (*Paścima-vibhāga*, fourth wave): "The *sthāyi-bhāva* of *vātsalya*, brought to fullness by *vibhāva* and the rest, is here called '*vatsala*' [rasa]." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.8.45): "Hari, whose glory is sung by the three Vedas, the Upaniṣads, the Sāṅkhya and Yoga scriptures and the Sātvata scriptures — she regarded Him as her own son."

Waking from the dream, Miśra is astonished and tells his friends —

এত শুনি' দ্বিজ গেলা হঞা আনন্দিত ।
মিশ্র জাগিয়া হইলা পরম বিস্মিত ॥ ৯১ ॥

eta śuni' dvija gelā hañā ānandita
so hearing the brāhmaṇa went away becoming pleased
miśra jāgiyā hailā parama vismita
Miśra waking became supremely astonished

91 At this the brāhmaṇa went away well pleased, and Miśra awoke in utter astonishment.

বন্ধু-বান্ধব-স্থানে স্বপ্ন কহিল ।
শুনিয়া সকল লোক বিস্মিত হইল ॥ ৯২ ॥

bandhu-bāndhava-sthāne svapna kahila
of friends and kinsmen in the presence the dream he told
śuniyā sakala loka vismita haila
hearing all the people astonished became

92 He told the dream to his friends and kinsmen, and all who heard it marvelled.

এইমত শিশুলীলা করে গৌরচন্দ্র ।
দিনে দিনে পিতা-মাতার বাড়িল আনন্দ ॥ ৯৩ ॥

ei mata śiśu-līlā kare gauracandra
in this way childhood pastimes does Gauracandra
dine dine pitā-mātāra bāḍila ānanda
day by day of father and mother grew the joy

93 Thus Gauracandra played His childhood pastimes, and day by day His parents' joy grew.

Nimāi takes the chalk in hand —

কত দিনে মিশ্র পুত্রের হাতে খড়ি দিল ।
অল্প দিনে দ্বাদশ-ফলা অক্ষর শিখিল ॥ ৯৪ ॥

kata dine miśra putrera hāte khaḍi dila
some days later Miśra his son's in the hand chalk placed
alpa dine dvādaśa-phalā akṣara śikhila
in a few days with the twelve phalās the letters He learnt

94 Some days later Miśra placed chalk in his son's hand, and within a few days He had learnt all the letters with their twelve *phalās*.

Anubhāṣya.
The twelve *phalās* (subscript signs): the *repha*, and the *ṇa*, *na*, *ma*, *ya*, *ra*, *la*, *va*, *ṛ*, *ṝ*, *ḷ* and *ḹ phalās*.

These childhood pastimes in brief; they are described in the Caitanya-bhāgavata —

বাল্যলীলা-সূত্র এই কহিল অনুক্রম ।
ইহা বিস্তারিয়াছেন দাস-বৃন্দাবন ॥ ৯৫ ॥

bālya-līlā-sūtra ei kahila anukrama
of the childhood pastimes outline this I have told in order
ihā vistāriyāchena dāsa-vṛndāvana
this has elaborated dāsa Vṛndāvana

95 This, in order, is the outline of His childhood pastimes; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them at length.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the fourteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

অতএব বাল্যলীলা সংক্ষেপে সূত্র কৈল ।
পুনরুক্তি-ভয়ে বিস্তারিয়া না কহিল ॥ ৯৬ ॥

ataeva bālya-līlā saṅkṣepe sūtra kaila
therefore the childhood pastimes in brief outline I made
punar-ukti-bhaye vistāriyā nā kahila
of repetition for fear at length not I told

96 Therefore I have outlined the childhood pastimes briefly and, for fear of repeating him, have not told them in detail.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৯৭ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

97 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Vara* means both "boon" and "bridegroom"; the girls worshipped the gods to win a good husband (cf. 54–55, 58). ↩